Strokes Gained
Cheat Sheet.

StrokesEdge
PGA TOUR BETTING ANALYSIS

1. THE FOUR CATEGORIES

CATEGORY	MEASURES
Off the tee	Driving on par 4s and 5s: distance and accuracy.
Approach	Iron and long shots into the green.
Around the green	Chipping, pitching and bunker play.
Putting	Everything on the green.
Tee to green	Off the tee + approach + around the green.
Total	All four categories.

2. HOW TO READ A NUMBER

Strokes gained compares each shot with the average result from the same spot for a reference field. **+0.50 per round** in a category means half a stroke better than average. A negative number is worse than average.

- Putting is the noisiest category. A hot putting week is a weaker signal than strong ball-striking.
- Data providers use different baselines. Never mix numbers or thresholds from two sources.
- A player with few recent rounds is unknown, not bad.

3. THE ODDS MATH

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Implied probability (+ odds) = 100 / (odds + 100)
Implied probability (- odds) = odds / (odds + 100)
Decimal odds D = 1 + profit / stake
Edge = your probability - implied probability
EV per $100 = 100 x (p x D - 1)
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Example: +1325 is decimal 14.25, so the implied chance is 100 / 1425 = **7.0%**. If you rate the player at 9%, the edge is +2.0 points and EV is +$28.25 per $100.

Every golf market adds up to more than 100%. The extra is the sportsbook's margin.

4. THE WEEKLY PROCESS

1. **Course.** Work out which categories have separated the field there.
2. **Weights.** Set the weight for each category and course-fit factor.
3. **Field.** Score every player and apply minimum thresholds. A player who fails can be a top 10 candidate, not an outright bet.
4. **Price.** Compare the model's probability with the market price. No gap, no bet.
5. **Size and log.** Fixed unit, every bet recorded, losers included.

5. WEIGHTS CHANGE BY COURSE (PUBLISHED STROKESEDGE EXAMPLES)

EVENT	APPROACH	OFF THE TEE	COURSE-FIT APPROACH	DRIVING DISTANCE FIT	AROUND THE GREEN	PUTTING
World Wide Technology Championship (El Cardonal, par 72, 7,452 yd)	20%	14%	10%	10%	10%	8%
VidantaWorld Mexico Open (Vidanta Vallarta, par 71, 7,337 yd)	19%	13%	10%	9%	8%	9%

Both are long courses where approach shots come from a distance, so approach leads. On a shorter course the order can change.

6. COMMON MISTAKES

- Betting only favorites, whose prices already reflect their quality.
- Trusting course history after a renovation or reroute.
- Betting before the field and the weather are confirmed.
- Ignoring the place terms on each-way bets.
- Not shopping for the best price across sportsbooks.

7. FREE TOOLS

- **Golf odds calculator:** strokesedge.com/golf-odds-calculator
- **Each-way calculator:** strokesedge.com/each-way-calculator
- **Every bet, public:** strokesedge.com/results
- **Methodology:** strokesedge.com/methodology

Want the full model for every player in the field? The weekly workbook is $7 per tournament, or included in the $21 monthly membership. Free picks every tournament week at strokesedge.com.